

“ONE NEEDS TO BE HONEST ENOUGH TO RECOGNISE THAT SEX IS THE MAIN CENTRE OF LIFE, NOT GOD, NOT PRAYERS AND NOT EVEN THE SOUL.”

SWAMI SATYA VEDANT

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SESSION CHAIRPERSON PRABHU CHAWLA (LEFT) WITH SWAMI RAMDEV AND SWAMI VEDANT

of two bodies; second is love which is the union of two hearts; third are prayers which is a union of the individual self with the universal self; and fourth, the beyond, a state which is beyond the mind, beyond the heart, beyond the body. So really speaking, if we are honest about it, sex is the central point that connects pleasure, joy, fear, love anger, longing, disease, and *samadhi*. One needs to be honest enough to recognise that sex is the main centre of life, not God, not prayer, not soul. But the only thing is that we have to go beyond it, one has to accept it and this is where I would like to quote Osho. He says, “And while you are meditating, your maturity comes sooner, your centering comes sooner, your awareness about things becomes clearer every day and sex is going to be the first victim of your awareness. The other things will follow because sex is the very root of your animality. Once sex drops off, as if the tree has lost its roots then

branches can't remain green any longer.” And he says your anger, your jealousy, your violence, your inferiority complex, your superiority complex, all kinds of your neurosis, psychosis, are just branches, they will start to die themselves once you have gone beyond sex without fighting with it. And then he concludes by saying, that is my basic difference with all religions, they have been trying to drop sex. I am not telling you to drop sex. Sex is to be accepted with deep respect, it is our heritage, we are born out of it. It is in our every fibre and every cell, to condemn it is to condemn oneself.

For full speech and discussion, click to:
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DISCUSSION

Q. Will you prefer spirituality or sex first?

Ramdev: As I mentioned sex leads to creation and spirituality is the ultimate destination. It means *vasana* (desire) should become *upaasna* (prayer).

Q. You said sex and spirituality are synonymous. Now as my energy is dimming with age, does that mean my spirituality will also disappear?

Ramdev: Before the age of 25 and after 75, there is no need of sex and you have to turn to me (for yoga and spirituality). Husband and wives should not be unfaithful to each other.

Vedant: The very concept of separating sex and spirituality is where the confusion is. The conflict arises because our views have become much dichotomised. We

see them totally as two different things; it has nothing to do with age. I have seen people at 90 enjoying sex. Because energy gained by this can be well utilised. If we understand this, then there will be no conflict.

Q. Is there a freedom of sex in spirituality?

Ramdev: There is full freedom but with dignity and decency. We have to understand that nothing is free in this world. As science describes, everything is dependent upon each other. Similarly, we all are free but dependent.

Vedant: I want to say that why should a third person interfere in the freedom of others? If two adults with consent are involved in sex, then why should I interfere? As per the question of ethics and morality, society has the right to control

things. People will become more perverted if they are not given enough opportunity to be themselves. I agree with you that there are certain limitations that the society has to follow but again the individual freedom and the individual choice should be in my opinion considered as paramount.

Q. In your path of spirituality, will you be able to experience the counterpart of orgasm with ecstasy of breath in your meditation and yoga?

Ramdev: In our life and in this world, nothing is destroyed but transformed. If I perform yoga and meditation, it does not mean I killed something. I did not kill the sex. I have transformed that energy into knowledge, love, compassion, service and courage.

Q. What about the time when

the society was not organised into the social institution called marriage? Was that a better situation to be in where anyone was free to have sex with anyone?

Vedant: In ancient times, people lived whichever way they wanted to, they lived like animals. It is only when the society began to organise, the system of marriage was introduced. Just remember one thing, the very word marriage means union. If there is no union, there is no marriage.

Q. Do you believe in flexibility in the institution of marriage?

Ramdev: I think marriage is just not a bond but it is a way of life to live together with commitment. If you are honest, then marriage does not matter.